



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

TRADE & CONTRACTOR RECEIVABLES · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Recovering unpaid plumbing invoices from customers who've stopped responding — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Smelscer Plumbing** · September 2026

A recovery partner for the invoices your office can't get answered

To the Smelscer Plumbing team — the hardest dollars a plumbing business collects are the ones a customer stops paying after the work is done and then stops returning calls. That silent, past-due account is the one we work every day.

Unpaid plumbing invoices aren't an office problem — they're a cash-flow problem.

Every balance past terms ties up money you've already earned in labor and materials.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced receivables recovery partner working residential and commercial balances on **pure contingency since 2004**, nationwide. You place accounts through a secure portal that takes an export from your billing system, and we work them. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of commercial recovery — nationwide

A documented, compliant recovery process on pure contingency since 2004 — scale you can add without building a collections desk.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSB • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

Your questions — answered directly

What happens to the invoices you hand us, in plain terms.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no minimum. A pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover, quoted once we've seen a representative sample of your aging.
2. Customers who've gone silent	The core of what we do: skip tracing plus persistent compliant multi-channel outreach. A third-party demand alone resolves a meaningful share of accounts your office can no longer reach.
3. 'The work was wrong'	A dispute pauses recovery, it doesn't end it. We validate against the signed estimate/work order, the invoice and job photos — separating a genuine dispute from a stall.
4. Residential & commercial	Homeowner balances under full FDCPA / Reg F consumer rules; commercial balances worked as B2B trade AR. One partner, one portal.
5. Onboarding	Bulk-upload an aging export — we map your columns. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement.

**THE SWRS CLIENT
PORTAL**

Billing-system-ready intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement runs through our secure portal — built to take your A/R exports and give your team live, self-service visibility throughout recovery.

BILLING-SYSTEM-READY PLACEMENT

Upload an A/R / aging export — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send invoices, contracts and supporting docs safely inside the portal — the documentation that resolves disputes fast.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — live status on every placed balance.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a debtor makes directly to you, so balances stay accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Trade & Contractor Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's trade and construction book, anonymized by sector, with an honest spread including a low performer.

HVAC & MECHANICAL

CONTRACTOR

Commercial mechanical

\$16K recovered

of ~\$18K placed

87% recovered

ROOFING & EXTERIOR TRADE

Commercial roofing

\$36K recovered

of ~\$41K placed

89% recovered

PLUMBING CONTRACTOR

Res. & commercial plumbing

\$35K recovered

of ~\$44K placed

79% recovered

MECHANICAL SERVICE & INSTALL

HVAC service

\$29K recovered

of ~\$70K placed

41% recovered

SITE & OUTDOOR CONSTRUCTION

Utility/site contractor

\$19K recovered

of ~\$65K placed

30% recovered

COMMERCIAL ELECTRICAL & BUILD

Large-project electrical

\$116K recovered

of ~\$645K placed

18% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE AGE CURVE

Why placing sooner recovers more

A trade balance is most collectible while it's fresh — the customer still remembers the job and the contact data is still good. Every month it ages, both erode.

FRESH VS. AGED

Accounts under ~90 days past due often resolve in 30–60 days; balances left to sit a year collect a fraction of that.

A STANDING RULE

A fixed 'place at 90 days' policy recovers materially more than letting balances drift toward write-off — and on contingency there's no cost to placing.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

Cutting the days between the job finishing and the invoice clearing

Finished work sitting as a receivable is working capital you can't redeploy. Every month past terms erodes both the recoverable value and the cash you need for the next job.



Non-responsive customers

Skip tracing on the customer — and, for commercial work, the business and its principals — plus persistent compliant demand.



Disputed invoices

Documentation-driven validation — estimates, work orders, job photos — that separates a warranty dispute from a stall.



Every balance type

Service-call invoices, install and replacement balances, maintenance dues and larger commercial jobs — one partner.



Nationwide reach

Recovery across all 50 states from 12 offices in 7 states.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for you

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Cost of Waiting: DSO & Commercial Recovery

B2B receivables · PDF

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Refusal vs. Dispute: Non-Responsive & Contested Invoices

Commercial AR · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

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The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's turn those unanswered invoices back into cash.

A 30-minute call to walk your past-due file, confirm the export handoff, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample of your accounts.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states • nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Smelscer Plumbing. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant • ACA International member.